



Understanding What Teams Need Next

A listening guide for the phase ahead — clarifying essential learning and looking closely at student work.

How to run this conversation

- Listen to understand, not to respond — don't sell the process or problem-solve in the room.
- Ask for stories, not opinions — "tell me about a time..." surfaces real needs.
- Follow curiosity — your best follow-ups are "Say more" and "Why?"
- Let silence sit; people fill it with what matters most.
- No attribution — you're gathering themes, not evaluating anyone.
- Keep it to 20–30 minutes, one question at a time. You don't have to ask them all.

Questions — and space to capture what you hear

Ask	What I heard
When you picture the next stretch of PLT work — digging into standards and what students are really learning — what's the first feeling that comes up?	
What are you hoping this next phase does for you and your students?	
What are you most worried about as we move into it?	
To choose an essential standard and agree on what "they've learned it" looks like, what would you need to feel confident? (examples, time, expertise, clearer materials...)	
When your team hits something it doesn't know how to do, what kind of support actually helps — and what doesn't?	
What's most likely to stall your team in this next phase — and what would help you keep going?	
Who's a student or group you're worried about, and what do you wish your team could figure out how to do for them?	

Ask	What I heard
If you could ask for one thing to make this next phase successful, what would it be?	
What haven't I asked that I should have?	

Close by thanking them and naming what's next: you'll gather themes across teams and build them into Meetings 5–8. This is listening, not evaluating.